

Employing in Qatar

What You Need to Know · Employment Hero HeroForce EOR · July 2026

What does the EOR handle for you?

- **Employment contracts** — compliant contracts under Qatar Labour Law
- **Monthly payroll** — salary payments in QAR via the Wage Protection System (WPS)
- **No income tax** — Qatar levies no personal income tax on employment income
- **End-of-service gratuity** — statutory lump-sum accrual and settlement administration
- **Leave and termination management** — notice periods and entitlements guidance

Employment Conditions

Contracts & Probation

Qatar was the first GCC country to introduce a non-discriminatory minimum wage (2021), applying equally to all private-sector workers regardless of nationality.

Item	Detail	Legal Basis
Probation period	Maximum 6 months	Qatar Labour Law
Non-discriminatory minimum wage	Applies equally to all workers regardless of nationality since 2021	Ministerial Decision, effective 20 March 2021
Mandatory food allowance	QAR 300/month if meals are not provided directly	Qatar Labour Law

Working Hours & Overtime

Rule	Detail	Authority
Standard hours	8 hrs/day, 48 hrs/week (6-day week)	Qatar Labour Law
Overtime premium	125% of hourly rate (150% for night work)	Qatar Labour Law

Minimum Wage & Statutory On-Costs (2026)

Measure	Rate	Notes
Minimum basic wage	QAR 1,000/month	Applies to all workers regardless of nationality
Minimum housing allowance (if not provided in kind)	QAR 500/month	Combined with food allowance, brings the minimum floor to ~QAR 1,800/month
Minimum food allowance (if not provided in kind)	QAR 300/month	Employer may provide meals directly instead
GRSIA (Qatari nationals only)	Employer 10%, employee 5%	Does not apply to expatriate employees

Leave Entitlements

Leave Type	Entitlement	Who Pays	Key Condition
Annual Leave	3 weeks/year (4 weeks after 5 years' service)	Employer	Qatar Labour Law minimum
Sick Leave	2 weeks full pay + 4 weeks half pay + unpaid thereafter	Employer	After 3 months' continuous service
Maternity Leave	50 days	Employer	Requires 1 year of service

★ HERO TIP

Qatar treats resignation and termination identically for gratuity purposes — unlike the UAE and Saudi Arabia, there is no reduction in the payout for employees who resign early, as long as they've completed at least 1 year of service. Gratuity is calculated on basic salary only (excluding housing, transport, food and bonus allowances) — a common source of employee disputes when the contract only shows an all-in salary figure.

Payroll, Tax & Contributions

Total Cost Example (Expatriate Employee) — USD \$3,000 Gross Monthly Salary

Cost Item	Amount (USD)	% of Gross
Gross salary	\$3,000.00	100%
End-of-service gratuity accrual (3 weeks/year ≈ 5.8%)	\$174.00	5.80%
EOR service fee (HeroForce, Tier 2)	\$600.00	20.00%
Estimated total monthly cost	~\$3,774.00	~125.8%

HeroForce EOR service fee shown at USD \$600 per employee per month (Tier 2 pricing), no setup fee. Expatriate employees have no personal income tax and no employee-side social insurance deduction — take-home pay equals gross salary. GRSIA applies only to Qatari nationals and is excluded from this example.

Termination & Separation

Notice periods are typically set by contract (commonly 1 month), with statutory minimums applying where the contract is silent. End-of-service gratuity is a minimum of 3 weeks' basic pay per year of service after 1 year — this rate applies equally regardless of whether the employee resigns or is dismissed, and there is no statutory cap on the total payout.

Public Holidays 2026

Date	Holiday	Type
18 December	Qatar National Day	National
~February	National Sports Day	National
~March/April	Eid al-Fitr (multi-day)	National (Islamic calendar)
~May/June	Eid al-Adha (multi-day)	National (Islamic calendar)

Islamic calendar holidays shift roughly 10–11 days earlier each Gregorian year and are confirmed by the Qatari government closer to the date.

Ready to hire in Qatar?

HeroForce by Employment Hero is an Employer of Record solution that handles hiring, contracts, compliance and payroll across 180+ countries.

Onboard your first Qatar employee in as little as one to two weeks — HeroForce EOR service fee: **USD \$600** per employee per month, no setup fee (Tier 2).